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TAB 17



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-288-25/26, **Version:** 1
In Control: Transportation Services

Agenda Date: 3/10/2026

Home-to-School Transportation Reimbursement - Transportation Services Plan Transportation Services Branch

Brief Description:

(Home-to-School Transportation Reimbursement - Transportation Services Plan) Recommends approval of the Transportation Services Plan 2026-27 as a condition to receive approximately \$68.3 million reimbursement from California Department of Education.

Action Proposed:

Approval of the Transportation Services Plan 2026-27 as a stipulation to receive reimbursement or apportionments from the California Department of Education (CDE) for home-to-school transportation services. Based on the formula provided, LAUSD will receive approximately \$68.3 million.

Background:

Home-to-School (HTS) Transportation Reimbursement was implemented by Assembly Bill (AB) 181 to provide reimbursement funding for school districts and county offices of education (COEs) based on the prior year eligible transportation expenditures and prior year Local Control Funding Formula (LCFF) transportation related add-on funding. As a condition of receiving the reimbursement, a plan describing the transportation services offered to students, including those in transitional kindergarten through grade 6 and students of low income be developed and adopted by the Board of Education. The plan shall be updated by April 1st of each year thereafter. In addition to describing the transportation services provided, the attached Transportation Services Plan 2026-27 addresses other requirements from the CDE.

Expected Outcomes:

As the prior year's transportation expenditure is greater than the provided transportation add-on funding from LCFF, the reimbursement shall offset a portion of the increased expenditures. The reimbursement will be apportioned in June 2026 as part of CDE's 2025-26 Second Principal Apportionment certification.

Board Options and Consequences:

If the Board votes 'NO,' the plan is rejected, and the District shall forgo the reimbursement

If the Board votes 'YES,' the plan is accepted, and the District shall receive \$68.3 million in home-to-school transportation reimbursement funding

Policy Implications:

Not Applicable

Budget Impact:

The 2025-26 HTS Reimbursement Funding is approximately \$68.3 million and is based on prior year's eligible home-to-school transportation expenditures and prior year's LCFF HTS add-on funding. As the prior year's

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transportation expenditure is greater than the provided transportation add-on funding from LCFF, the reimbursement shall offset a portion of the increased expenditures. The reimbursement will be apportioned in June 2026 as part of CDE's 2025-26 Second Principal Apportionment certification. Any additional reimbursement will further reduce the District's transportation costs.

Student Impact:

The reimbursement will assist the District's Transportation Services Branch (TSB) with providing safe and efficient home-to-school transportation services for students.

Equity Impact:

Component	Score	Score Rationale
Recognition	3	The approval of the Transportation Services Plan affirms the District's commitment to providing transportation services for all students in transportation programs. This is especially important for students who reside in communities that are environmentally and economically impacted.
Resource Prioritization	3	The Transportation Services Plan applies to all students enrolled in education programs with qualifying transportation services.
Results	4	The goal of the Transportation Services Branch is to deliver all qualifying students to schools on time everyday, so they have the opportunity to learn.
TOTAL	10	

Issues and Analysis:

Not Applicable

Attachments:

Attachment A - Transportation Services Plan 2026-27

Submitted:

02/12/26

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RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,



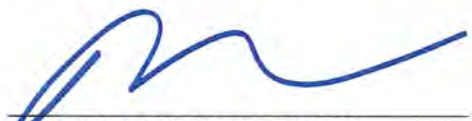
ANDRES E. CHAIT
Acting Superintendent

APPROVED BY:



PEDRO SALCIDO
Deputy Superintendent
Business Services and Operations

REVIEWED BY:



DEVORA NAVERA REED
General Counsel

✓ Approved as to form.

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:



DANIEL KANG
Director
Transportation Services Branch

REVIEWED BY:



KURT E. JOHN
Deputy Chief Financial Officer

✓ Approved as to budget impact statement.

ATTACHMENT A TRANSPORTATION SERVICES PLAN 2026-27

Pursuant to Education Code Section 39800.1, as a condition of receiving apportionments for Transportation Services under Section 41850.1, a local educational agency shall develop a plan describing the transportation services. The plan shall be presented and adopted by the governing board of the local educational agency on or before April 1, 2026, in an open meeting with the opportunity for in-person and remote public comment. The plan may provide for the local educational agency to partner with a municipally owned transit system to provide service pursuant to this section to middle school and high school pupils. Nothing in a local educational agency's plan shall preclude a local educational agency from providing no-cost transit passes to pupils.

1. Enter description of your district's plan of the transportation services it will offer to pupils, and how it will prioritize transportation services for pupils in transitional kindergarten, kindergarten, and any of grades 1 to 6, inclusive, and pupils who are low income.

The Los Angeles Unified School District (LAUSD) provides home-to-school transportation services for eligible students enrolled in Special Education, student integration, and other District transportation programs. Eligible students in these programs include, but are not limited to, low-income pupils and/or pupils enrolled in grades transitional kindergarten through 12.

- **Magnet:** A voluntary program drawing students from throughout LAUSD into specialized school programs. Transporting students to Magnet schools offers them access to special learning environments by which students can pursue their academic interests. Students served: 12,500
- **Special Education:** A District-wide program that serves students with disabilities as determined by their Individualized Education Program (IEP). In accordance with Free Appropriate Public Education (FAPE), if necessary, students with disabilities are transported to District schools that provide programs and services appropriate to their educational needs. Students served: 9,300
- **Distance and Hazard:** Transportation is provided for students whose walk routes from home to school and back are potentially hazardous. Students served: 1,300
- **Homeless/Foster:** Transportation is provided to students who are experiencing homelessness or are residing in foster care. Students served: 94
- **Permits with Transportation (PWT):** A voluntary student integration program designed to provide students with integrated experiences with other student populations at different schools. Students served: 30
- **Transportation for All:** As space is available, transportation is offered to all students who are not in the aforementioned programs. Initiated in 2023-24, the program supports the District's Strategic Plan to expand transportation opportunities to promote equitable access of District resources for all students. Students served: 3,700

- **Non-Routine Transportation:** Transportation is offered for students impacted by immigration enforcement and students experiencing chronic absenteeism. Providing transportation helps with reducing barriers that contribute to absenteeism such as safety concerns. Students Served: 900

2. Enter description of your district's transportation services that would be accessible to pupils with disabilities, and homeless children and youth.

Transportation is provided to Special Education students and those experiencing homelessness and/or residing in foster care. Transportation for pupils with disabilities is provided regardless of the proximity of the child's home to the school of attendance based on the child's IEP. In addition, school-to-school transportation during the day is provided for Special Needs students to attend therapies and other related activities.

3. Enter description of how unduplicated pupils would be able to access available home-to-school transportation at no cost to the pupils.

Regardless of the student's "unduplicated pupil" status, LAUSD's school bus transportation services are provided at no cost to students enrolled in one of the District's transportation programs.

4. Your plan must be developed in consultation with classified staff, teachers, school administrators, regional local transit authorities, local air pollution control districts and air quality management districts, parents, pupils, and other stakeholders. Enter description of your plan consultation with those parties.

LAUSD has and will continue to consult with internal and external stakeholders to evolve the District's transportation programs. LAUSD's Transportation office works with internal stakeholders such as the Magnet Office, Special Education Office, and District region offices to assign students to bus routes. School administrators are consulted to identify student populations for transportation. The District also works with state and local agencies to ensure that the District's buses comply with emissions and safety regulations.

Transportation Services Allowance Calculations

Component	Component Description and Calculation, if applicable	FY 2025-26
A	PY Transportation expenditures in SACS Function 3600, excluding capital outlay and non-agency expenditures	\$255,244,185
B	Expenditure amount for reimbursement, <i>EC Section 41850.1(a)</i> (Component A x 60%)	\$153,146,511
C	PY LCFF Add -on Amount	\$84,863,980
D	CY HTS Transportation Reimbursement (Component B - Component C)	\$68,282,531